

Secondary 1



English Language Department
Essay Practice 2026

Name: Li Xinyang

[17]

Class: 102

Date: 10/4/26

Essay Writing [30 Marks]

You are advised to write a story between 350 and 500 words on **one** of the following topics. In the left margin, write the number of the question you have chosen.

1. Write a story that must include this line at any point in the story: "When the door opened, he leapt to his feet but it was too late." — cannot be a random line, and related to the plot.
2. Write a story entitled, 'Happiness.'
3. Write a story set **mainly** in a desert. — Your main actions, thoughts, events, ... should happen in the desert. *character development*
4. Write a story that features a case of mistaken identity.
5. Write a story that includes **any two** of the following items:
They must form an important point
 - A coin
 - A sword
 - A ghost



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HWA CHONG
INSTITUTE

English Language Department
Essay Practice 1 2026

Name :

Li Xinyang

[11]

Class: 102

Date: 13/4/26

Essay Writing [30 Marks]

You are advised to write a story between 350 and 500 words on **one** of the following topics. In the left margin, write the number of the question you have chosen.

1. Write a story that must include this line at any point in the story: "When the door opened, he leapt to his face but it was too late."
2. Write a story entitled, 'The Game.'
3. Write a story set mainly in a desert.
4. Write a story that features a case of a life-changing decision.
5. Write a story that includes any two of the following items:
 - A storm
 - A teenager with a disability
 - A pair of boots



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NAME Li Xinyun SUBJECT English MARKS

INDEX NO. 17 CLASS 102 DATE 13/4/26

4.

The sun ~~shone~~ ^{shone} brightly across the clear blue sky, I was walking across the path pavement to my house. ~~I had~~ My family was not doing well ~~as~~ since my father, the sole bread-winner, ~~has~~ lost his job one week ago ~~and~~ but we still could ~~eat~~ ^{afford} three meals for our family. I had recently attended a science olympiad ^{which is gold} and ~~was~~ ^{is} really excited to get my results ^{as} if I got top 10, I could go to America to participate in bigger science olympiad ^{exp} which ~~will~~ ^{can} get me a scholarship to go to America to study.

When I reached home,

I eagerly ~~opened~~ ^{hopped} onto my chair ~~to~~, opened my ~~computer~~ ^{computer} and check my email. As ~~as~~ expected, there was a ^{email} mail labeled ~~as~~ 'Science Olympiad Results'. I immediately opened it and slowly scrolled down to find out my score. On the letter it wrote "The GOLD AWARD is ~~now~~ proudly presented to John Smith." ^{pin} once I read the message, I could not believe my eyes! It took me a while till I got back to my senses before screaming, "Dad! Mom! I can go to America! I got gold for the science competition!" Five seconds later, they rushed into my room and the mail before ~~congratulating~~ congratulating me. However, it was not to long till their faces turned dark.

"Darling we are very proud of you, but... we can't really afford for you to go to America... I'm very sorry" she said, trailing off. A wave of disappointment swept over me, my entire body was filled with sadness. They slowly walked out of my room, leaving me staring at my computer. Tears welled up in my eyes as I filled up the form. However, I did not click 'submit'. Over the ~~per~~ ^{next} few days, I ~~was~~ was down in the dumps, and I used all my time thinking how could I get money to pay for the flight. ~~Usually~~ ^{usually} ^{a week} announcement ~~at the~~ Usually, my ~~parents~~ ^{father} would be mostly at home, however, ~~after~~ ^{after} the result of the competition, ~~they~~ ^{he} ~~came~~ would come back late at night looking tired. I thought, that he was just doing his own things ^{exp} and I did not overthink.

Plot narration.

A week before the submission of the science olympiad form, I realised that my father had been ~~work~~^{working} as cleaner and even working late in the night to pay for me to go to America. Seeing his exhausted face every night makes me feel guilty. For my father to stop working very hard, I tried to convince him to not go to America to study. Dad ?? So is your father the one going to America to study?

"Dad, it is alright if ~~he~~^{he} can't go to America to study, you do not need to overwork." I convinced him?

"It is fine son, this is for your development, nothing tires me if it's for my son." he replied, with a warm smile hanging on his face. After hearing his words, I ~~was~~^{was} determined to make my father proud and pay him back for his care and support. I immediately ~~studied~~^{decided to sign up and} studied very hard, late into the night to win the grand prize in the competition in America. Just one day before the submission of the form, my father accumulated enough money to pay for me to go to America to study, and I immediately filled up the form and submitted it.

very flat and rushed
No development at all!

After I boarded my flight and arrived at the competition site, I started doing the questions as well as possible and won third place. From the prize, I have gotten \$500 and was enough to repay my father's hard work. In America, I continued to compete in Science and continued to win many awards. That decision was definitely life-changing! However, without my father's help, it would have never been possible.

C - 5/15

L - 9/15

15/30
14

C - Xinyang, there is no plot or action in your essay. It's a flat narration of finding out he got a place.

L - many large errors in your work.



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HWA CHONG INSTITUTION (HIGH SCHOOL SECTION)
SECONDARY 1 ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE 2026

Name: Li Xinyang (17) Class: 102 Date: 1/13/2026

Introduction to Elements of Fiction/ Narratives

Dear Gentlemen. We will be re-visiting some concepts and ideas that would already be quite familiar to you. Nevertheless, the aim is to deepen our understanding and sharpen the way we think about stories and apply the skills in our writing.

Lesson objectives: By the end this lesson package-

You should be able to:

1. Understand the elements of a short story
2. Identify the important elements/ingredients that make up a good story
3. Apply the conventions of narrative writing in your work

Pause, Think & Respond 1:

Think of the stories you have enjoyed reading/ viewing/ listening to. List down a few of your favourites!

What do you think makes a compelling story? What "ingredients" make a compelling story?

- engages our interest / satisfaction
- Plot twist — unexpected (ending?) (middle?)
 - Cliff hangers
 - Different perspectives
 - Humour
 - simple + not overly complex
 - ↳ not too many events
 - X confuse the reader
 - ✓ Logical + all accounted for
- author The reader would like to leave some clues and hints for the reader to figure out.
- action! + suspense!
 - ↳ foreshadowing! + technique
 - ~~one liner dramatic~~
 - Characterisation
 - ↳ interesting
 - ↳ background; dialogue; thoughts?
 - Relationships + Dynamics between characters

Pause, Think & Respond 2:

When you think about the stories and movies we enjoy, what similarities do you observe? Why is it that these stories continue to move us, the reader? List as many attributes as you can think of!

Captivating stories move us by featuring relatable characters facing high-stakes conflicts. By creating narrative tension, these story stories trigger deep emotional investment, ~~and~~ They allow us to explore complex moral dilemmas while satisfying a human need for meaning and resolution.

One character is clearly central to the story with all major events having some importance to this character - he/she is the PROTAGONIST. The person/force that opposes the main character is called the Antagonist

1. What is CHARACTERISATION?

Characterisation is v characters unique personalities ~~and~~ to make the story more giving

it's interesting by adding background, to the dialogue and thoughts to the character.

Characterisation is a word that describes how the author develops the personality of the ~~story~~ characters in a story. Persons in a work of fiction - Antagonist and Protagonist

Flat VS Round Characters

FLAT: Remain the same throughout
Have one or 2 traits

Round: Go through experiences and change

Flat characters are characters that do not have ^{much} change in the story.

Round characters usually defy "moral dichotomies" and makes the story more interesting, they are sometimes grey.

dichotomy: a division or contrast between two things that are, or are ~~very~~ represented as being opposed or entirely different.

Pause, Think & Respond 4:

How do writers bring their fictional characters to life?? How are characters developed?

[Hint: Follow the principle of "Show, not tell"]

- ① Feelings / Emotions
- ② Traits/Qualities
- ③ Reactions/Actions
- ④ Growth /Transformation
- ⑤ Conflicts (Internal)
- ⑥ Dialogue
- ⑦ Appearance

- 1 Conradin was ten years old, and the doctor had pronounced his professional opinion that the boy would not live another five years. The doctor's opinion counted for little, but it was endorsed by Mrs. de Ropp, whose opinion counted for nearly everything. Mrs. De Ropp was Conradin's cousin and guardian, and he perceived her as necessary, disagreeable and real. One of these days, Conradin supposed he would succumb to his illnesses and coddling restrictions and drawn-out dullness. Without his imagination, which was rampant under the spur of loneliness, he would have succumbed long ago. 5
- 2 Mrs. de Ropp would never, in her most honest-moments, have confessed to herself that she disliked Conradin. But she was dimly aware that preventing him from having fun was a duty which she did not find particularly irksome. Conradin hated her with a desperate sincerity which he was perfectly able to mask. Such few pleasures as he could devise for himself gained an added relish from the likelihood that they would be displeasing to his guardian. 10 15
- 3 In the dull, cheerless garden, overlooked by so many windows that were ready to open with a message not to do this or that, or a reminder that medicines were due, he found little attraction. In a forgotten corner, however, almost hidden behind a dismal shrubbery, was a disused tool-shed and within its walls, Conradin found a haven. In one corner lived a Houdan hen with tattered plumage, on which the boy lavished an affection that had scarcely another outlet. Further back in the gloom stood a large hutch, divided into two compartments, one of which was fronted with close iron bars. This was the abode of a large ferret, which a friendly butcher-boy had once smuggled into its present quarters, in exchange for a small hoard of silver. Conradin was dreadfully afraid of the lithe, sharp-fanged beast, but it was his most treasured possession. Its very presence in the tool-shed was a secret and fearful joy, to be kept from the knowledge of his cousin. And one day, he spun the beast a wonderful name, and it grew into a god. Every Thursday, in the dim and musty silence of the wooden hutch, he worshipped Sredni Vashtar, the great ferret. 20 25 30
- 4 After a while, Conradin's absorption in the tool-shed began to attract the notice of his guardian. "It is not good for him to be pottering down there in all weathers," she promptly decided. And at breakfast one morning, she announced that the Houdan hen had been sold and taken away overnight. With her short-sighted eyes she peered at Conradin, waiting 35

~~ferret~~
fierce
agile, dangerous

terrified

for an outbreak of rage and sorrow. But Conradin said nothing: there was nothing to be said. Something perhaps in his white set face gave her a moment of regret, for at tea that afternoon there was toast on the table, a delicacy which she usually banned on the ground that it was bad for him. 40

"I thought you liked toast," she exclaimed, with an injured air, observing that he did not touch it. 45

"Sometimes," said Conradin.

And Conradin went back to the world he so hated.

5 And every night, in the darkness of his bedroom, and every evening in the dusk of the tool-shed, Conradin chanted: "Do one thing for me, Sredni Vashtar." 50

Mrs. de Ropp noticed that the visits to the shed did not cease, and one day she made a further journey of inspection.

"What are you keeping in that locked hutch?" she asked. "I believe it's guinea-pigs. I'll have them all cleared away."

Conradin shut his lips tight, but Mrs de Ropp ransacked his bedroom till she found the carefully hidden key, and marched down to the shed to complete her discovery. 55

6 It was a cold afternoon, and Conradin had been ordered to remain in the house. From the furthest window of the dining-room, the door of the shed could just be seen beyond the corner of the shrubbery, and there Conradin stationed himself. He saw Mrs de Ropp enter, and then he imagined her opening the door of the hutch and peering down with her short-sighted eyes into the thick straw bed where his god lay hidden. Perhaps she would prod at the straw in her impatience. And Conradin fervently breathed his prayer for the last time. But he knew as he prayed that he did not believe. He knew that his cousin would come out presently with that smile he loathed so well on her face, and that in an hour or two the gardener would carry away his wonderful god, a god no longer, but a simple brown ferret in a hutch. And he knew that Mrs de Ropp, would triumph always as she triumphed now. 60 65 70

7 And then, all of a sudden he stopped his chanting and drew closer to the window-pane. The door of the shed still stood ajar as it had been left, and the minutes were slipping by. They were long minutes, but they slipped by nevertheless. A maid came in to lay the table for tea, and still, Conradin stood and waited and watched. Hope had crept by inches into 75 his heart, and now a look of triumph began to blaze in his eyes. Presently his eyes were rewarded: out through that doorway came a long, low, yellow-and-brown beast, with eyes a-blink at the waning daylight, and dark wet stains around the fur of jaws and throat. The great ferret made its way down to a small brook at the foot of the garden, drank for a 80 moment, and then disappeared in the bushes. Such was the passing of Sredni Vashtar.

8 "Tea is ready," said the maid, "where is the mistress?"

"She went down to the shed some time ago," said Conradin.

9 And while the maid went to summon her mistress to tea, Conradin 85 proceeded to toast himself a piece of bread. And during the toasting of it and the buttering of it with much butter and the slow enjoyment of eating it, Conradin listened to the noises and silences which fell in quick spasms beyond the dining-room door. The loud foolish screaming of the maid, the scuttering footsteps and hurried calls for help, and then, after 90 a lull, the scared sobbings and the shuffling tread of those who bore a heavy burden into the house.

10 "Whoever will break it to the poor child? I couldn't for the life of me!" exclaimed a shrill voice. And while they debated the matter among themselves, Conradin made himself another piece of toast. 95

Adapted from Sredni Vashtar by Saki (H.H.Munro)

Section A [20M]

From Paragraph 1

1. Cite one word from this paragraph which has the same meaning as "give in". [1m]
2. "...he perceived her as necessary, disagreeable and real." (Lines 5-6) [1m]
What is your impression of Mrs de Ropp from the underlined words?
3. Why was imagination very important to Conradin? [1m]

From Paragraph 2

4. Quote an expression that shows that Mrs de Ropp enjoyed tormenting Conradin. [1m]
5. Cite one word that suggests Conradin also enjoyed "displeasing" his guardian (Line 16). [1m]

From Paragraph 3

- 6a) "In the dull, cheerless garden, overlooked by so many windows that were ready to open with a message not to do this or that..." (Lines 17 – 18). [1m]
Identify the literary device used in the underlined expression.
- 6b) What is the writer's purpose in mentioning the "many windows"? [1m]
7. Explain **in your own words**, why Conradin described the ferret as a "fearful joy" (Line 30). [2m]

From Paragraph 4

8. How did Mrs de Ropp expect Conradin to react on hearing that his hen had been sold? [2m]
9. Suggest two reasons why Mrs de Ropp offered toast at tea for Conradin. [2m]
10. If you were Mrs de Ropp, how would you feel when Conradin did not touch the toast? [1m]

From Paragraph 5

11. *"Do one thing for me, Sredni Vashtar"* (Lines 49 - 50) [1m]
What do you think Conradin was asking Sredni Vashtar to do?
12. Explain **in your own words**, what Mrs de Ropp did when she suspected that Conradin was keeping guinea-pigs in the hutch. [2m]

From Paragraph 7

13. *"Hope had crept by inches into his heart."* (Lines 75-76) [1m]
Explain what this expression reveals about Conradin's thoughts.

From Paragraph 10

14. Explain clearly, the irony in the last paragraph of the story. [2m]

SECTION B – SUMMARY [20m]

Begin on a fresh sheet of paper

Imagine you are Conradin.

USING ONLY MATERIAL FROM PARAGRAPHS 6 TO 9, describe what you saw, heard and imagined from the moment you saw Mrs de Ropp enter the shed to the end of paragraph 9.

Your summary, which must be in continuous writing (not note form), must not be longer than **120** words ((not counting the words given below to help you begin))

Begin your summary as follows:

From where I stood in the dining-room, I could ...

END OF PAPER



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HWA CHONG INSTITUTION

NAME Li Xinyang SUBJECT English MARKS

INDEX NO. 17 CLASS 102 DATE 23/1/26

Comprehension Paper 2 Time Practice 1

1. succumb ✓

2. My impression of Mrs De Ropp is that she has the power and

authority to control Conradin and ^{is} disliked by him.

Give a clear adjective to address c 92.

3. Imagination was the reason why Conradin did not succumb to his illnesses

and coddling restrictions and drawn-out dullness.

4. "preventing him from having fun was a duty ^{which} she did not find particularly irksome."

5. ~~pleasures~~

6a. ~~Simile~~

6b. The writer's purpose is to mention that Mrs De Ropp is able to look through

~~those windows to watch what Conradin is doing~~ and tell him not to

do this or that, or a reminder that medicines were due, so. Conradin

not attracted.??

7. Conradin was scared that the large ferret would be found out by

0 Mrs De Ropp, while he was glad as it was his most treasured possession. X

2 8. Mrs De Ropp expected that Conradin would have an outbreak of rage and sorrow, ~~she~~ she also expected that he would eat the toast she had prepared for him.

1 9. Mrs De Ropp felt a moment of regret when she saw Conradin's white face after she announced that Houden ~~Hallen~~ ^{taken} had been sold - and to be away overnight. She also thought he liked toast.

10. I would feel surprised X as he ~~was~~ usually liked toast.

11. Conradin wanted Sredni Vachtar to kill Mrs De Ropp.

12. Mrs De Ropp went to his bedroom and found the key, she then went to the shed and found the second ~~compa~~ compartment and used the key to open the iron bars. Since she, thought the ferret was a guinea-pig, she opened the cage and let the ferret out.

was becoming more hopeful
13. Conradin's ~~hope~~ of the ferret, Sredni Vashtar, killing Mrs De Ropp ~~was~~ as she did not come out of the shed even after a long time.

14. Conradin * made himself another piece of toast which Mrs De Ropp would never allow him to eat; ~~how~~ However, since she was killed by the ferret, ~~he~~ ~~mad~~ she could no longer control him.

(9/20)



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HWA CHONG INSTITUTION

NAME Li Xinyang

SUBJECT English Lit

MARKS _____

INDEX NO. 17

CLASS 102

DATE 2/2/26

Literal Qn

Q1 "succumb"/ "succumbed"

The word is

Inference Qn Skills: Interpret and Infer what is implied about her

Replace necessary, disagreeable and real

Q2 Mrs de Ropp is a strict / authoritative / dictatorial / domineering person

X Describing what she does - e.g. she tends not to listen to Conradin

X Red herring - the sentences about her opinions in the paragraph!

Literal Qn

Q3 Imagination was important as that helped Conradin not to succumb to his illnesses, coddling restrictions and drawn-out dullness.

Without his imagination, which was rampant under the ^{spur} of loneliness, he would have succumbed long ago.

Quote an expression ^{phrase} ~~sentence~~

Use of language Qn

Q4 The expression is "preventing him from having fun was a duty which she did not find particularly irksome."

X Do not accept it the whole sentence is lifted

Cite one word

Literal Qn

Q5 The word is "relish".

Use of Language Qn

Q6a The literary device is Personification!

[Spelling errors will be penalized]

Inference Qn [What is the writer to show/imply]

Q6b The writer's purpose was to indicate/imply/reinforce that Conradin was constantly watched by his oppressive guardian.
being

X to remind him not to do this or that [lifting]

X many opportunities to escape/to have fun

"fearful joy"

Use of own words Qn VYOW ~~creat~~ it first like a Literal Qn

① Find 6 answers/points in 6 paragraph.

② Paraphrase Key words/ideas.

Q7 He was terribly frightened/scared/terrified of the ferret as it was dangerous and could attack him/ as it looked ferocious with its piercing teeth. ~~Priceless~~

Joy: Yet, he derived happiness from keeping the ferret as something unknown from his ~~cousin~~ cousin.

Treasured: Priceless property/precious thing/prized belonging/valued the greater
Possession



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NAME _____ SUBJECT _____ MARKS _____
INDEX NO. _____ CLASS _____ DATE _____

Literal Qn

28 She expected him to break out in rage and sorrow

Note: Do NOT paraphrase "rage" and "sorrow" since it is a Literal Qn

Inference Qn [Excess denied applies]

Q9 She felt guilty/regret for selling the hen/wanted to apologise to him.

She wanted to make it up to him for selling the hen. ~~compa~~ (compensate).

She wanted to cheer Conradin up. (comfort/console)

She wanted to show that she was a nice person.

She did not want Conradin to blame/hat her for it.

Inference Qn

Q10 I would feel unappreciated / hurt (an injured a/c) / disappointed
disheartened / slighted / offended.

Inference Qn

Q11 He wanted it to harm / to get rid of / to ~~injo~~ injure / to kill his cousin / to
take revenge on his cousin for selling his hen / teach his cousin a lesson.

Inference Qn

QB Conradin was optimistic that the ferret was alive.

Inference Qn IRONY

Q14 The other people in the story assumed the boy would be upset by the death of his cousin. However, Conradin was not bothered about it by eating another piece of toast.



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HWA CHONG INSTITUTION (HIGH SCHOOL SECTION)
SECONDARY 1 ENGLISH LANGUAGE & LITERATURE 2026Name: Li Xinyang (17) Class: 102 Date: 30/1/26**Summary Writing Skills – “Sredni Vashtar” Comprehension Practice 1****Summary Question [Section B]:**

Imagine you are Conradin.

USING ONLY MATERIAL FROM PARAGRAPHS 6 TO 9, describe what you **saw**, **heard** and **imagined** from the moment you **saw** Mrs de Ropp enter the shed to the end of paragraph 9.

Your summary, which must be in continuous writing (not note form), must not be longer than **120 words** ((not counting the words given below to help you begin))

Begin your summary as follows:

From where I stood in the dining-room, I could ...

Instructions:

Paragraphs 6 to 9 have been extracted from the full-length passage, for the summary practice. Highlight and number the points.

Real answer: —

- 6 It was a cold afternoon, and Conradin had been ordered to remain in the house. From the furthest window of the dining-room, the door of the shed could just be seen beyond the corner of the shrubbery, and there 60
- Saw* ← Conradin stationed himself. He saw Mrs de Ropp enter ⁽¹⁾ and then he ⁽²⁾
- imagines* imagined her opening the door of the hutch and peering down with her
- short-sighted eyes into the thick straw bed where his god lay hidden. ⁽³⁾ *imagine*
- ⁽⁴⁾ *imagine* Perhaps she would prod at the straw in her impatience. And Conradin
- fervently breathed his prayer for the last time. But he knew as he prayed 65
- that he did not believe. He knew that his cousin would come out *imagine*
- presently with that smile he loathed so well on her face ⁽⁵⁾ *imagine*
- and that in an hour or two the gardener would carry away his wonderful god, a god no ⁽⁶⁾ *imagine*
- longer, but a simple brown ferret in a hutch. And he knew that Mrs de
- Ropp, would triumph always as she triumphed now.

70

(7)

imagine

7 And then, all of a sudden he stopped his chanting and drew closer to the
 (8) window-pane. The door of the shed still stood ajar as it had been left,
and the minutes were slipping by. They were long minutes, but they
slipped by nevertheless. A maid came in to lay the table for tea, and still, → (9)
Conradin stood and waited and watched. Hope had crept by inches into, 75
his heart, and now a look of triumph began to blaze in his eyes. Presently
his eyes were rewarded: out through that doorway came a long, low,
yellow-and-brown beast, with eyes a-blink at the waning daylight, and
dark wet stains around the fur of jaws and throat. The great ferret made
its way down to a small brook at the foot of the garden, drank for a 80
moment, and then disappeared in the bushes. Such was the passing of
Sredni Vashtar. (10)

8 "Tea is ready," said the maid, "where is the mistress?"

"She went down to the shed some time ago," said Conradin.

9 And while the maid went to summon her mistress to tea, Conradin 85
 proceeded to toast himself a piece of bread. And during the toasting of 8
 it and the buttering of it with much butter and the slow enjoyment of
 eating it, Conradin listened to the noises and silences which fell in quick
 spasms beyond the dining-room door. The loud foolish screaming of the 9
maid, the scuttering footsteps and hurried calls for help, and then, after → (11)
a lull, the scared sobbings and the shuffling tread of those who bore a 90
heavy burden into the house. 10
 (12)

10 "Whoever will break it to the poor child? I couldn't for the life of me!" 8
 exclaimed a shrill voice. And while they debated the matter among
 themselves, Conradin made himself another piece of toast. 95